

If the Desktop freezes

The problem of graphical desktop freezes is a common one on Linux. The only way to counter it is by dropping a console by clicking (Ctrl+alt+F2). This command will bring an independent environment. You have to login further.

This command will enable you to kill the notion that might have blocked your desktop. By dropping the console you can run the command and easily find process number.

Find out the issue

In order to encounter the possible reasons causing malfunctioning, you don't have to compromise with the commands.

```
$ top
top - 12:07:33 up 4:13, 7 users, load average: 0.56, 0.38, 0.34
[...]
PID USER VIRT RES %CPU MEM% COMMAND
6399 carla 493m 27m 94.2 0.2 konsole
4386 carla 1937m 819m 2.0 5.1 firefox
1511 root 613m 189m 1.3 1.2 Xorg
```

In the given output, you can easily see the process ID and it would be easy for you to figure out which processes you need to kill first.

Perform logging

The major services prevailing over Linux log the whole sequence of the activities. Logging into car/log, the results are likely to appear as CUPS, syslog, Kern.lg, Dmesg, boot, and udev. When the services are installed they have logging configuration to show the location and further details can be chosen. In order to debug urgently consider-

- Debug
- Info
- Warning
- Notice
- Error
- Critical
- Alert
- Emergency

By selecting 'emergency' you can easily minimize the amount of information. With the help of log files, you can easily solve a number of problems.